WEEK 6. MARKETING COMPARISON

Student: Assel Saginayeva Group: AIB-2602 Company B: JSC Bayan Sulu (Company A: Ferrero)

Goal: compare the SAME marketing task performed by a human-only approach and an AI-supported approach. Use documented facts where available; clearly label any hypothetical workflow or predicted KPI.

A. Customer and marketing context

Customer segment (who, needs, evidence/source):
Who: halal-seeking families in the Gulf (UAE first) who buy sweets to share at home, with guests and on holidays – a possible new market for Bayan Sulu, not yet a current one [4].

Needs: a clear halal mark and readable label, good taste, a fair price and a brand they can trust. **Evidence:** at Gulfood, Dubai (26–30 Jan 2026), its first international exhibition, Bayan Sulu held B2B meetings with UAE partners and noted strong demand for halal-certified products [4]; it already exports about 40% of output to 14 countries [2].

Product/service and value proposition:
Product: Bayan Sulu packaged confectionery – chocolate, candies, caramel, waffles, cookies, marshmallow and marmalade (300+ products), made in Kostanay since 1974 [2].

Value proposition: "sweets from a brand families have trusted for 50+ years" [4] – clearly labelled, halal-marked confectionery for family sharing at a fair price, as an alternative to global brands such as Ferrero.

Customer journey: Awareness → Consideration → Purchase → Experience → Retention. Identify one friction point:
Awareness: Gulfood stand and B2B meetings with UAE partners [4] → **Consideration:** "Is it halal? Is it good?" → **Purchase:** one importer → supermarkets and online shops → **Experience:** "same taste every time" → **Retention:** loyalty offer after the first purchase, only with consent [5].

Friction point (Consideration): Gulf families do not know the brand yet. Without a clear halal mark, Arabic/English information and online reviews, they choose a familiar global brand instead.

So the launch message must answer "Is it halal? Is it good?" in the customer's own language before any price or loyalty offer can work. (Reasoned from [4]; not measured.)

B. Same task, two approaches

Specific marketing task (e.g., draft a customer email; select audience; analyse feedback):
Promotion: draft the launch ad messages for halal-seeking Gulf families (Arabic, English, Kazakh) that answer "Is it halal? Is it good?" – hypothetical workflow, one product line.

Criterion	Human-only	AI-supported
Inputs / data	Gulfood notes and partner meetings [4], shop visits, distributor advice, brand book.	Same facts plus online reviews and UAE competitor ads/prices in Arabic and English, given to a generative AI tool. No personal data.
Steps & responsible actor	Marketing manager writes the brief → one agency writes one campaign → translator translates → brand manager approves.	Marketer writes brief and prompt → AI drafts many versions per group and language → native speaker and brand manager edit and choose.
Time / resources	Hypothetical: weeks of agency and translator work; one message for everybody.	Hypothetical: drafts in hours; costs are the AI tool and reviewer time. Volume rises, review work rises too.
Expected quality	Strong brand voice and local feel, but few versions and slow to change.	Many tailored versions, but risk of off-brand tone, bad translation or invented claims.

Privacy / bias risks	Low privacy risk; one team's view of a new market may miss local taste.	No personal data in prompts; AI may miss local taste or use stereotypes; uneven quality across languages [7].
Human review & approval	Brand manager signs off the final campaign.	Mandatory: native speaker + brand manager approve every ad; quality team checks halal/label claims; approval saved with name and date. AI never publishes [5], [7].

Use the rows above for: inputs/data; steps and responsible actor; time/resources; expected quality; privacy/bias risks; human review and approval.

C. Method and result

Comparison method: what input, prompt/instructions, sample or evaluation criteria did you use?
Method: one real case (Gulfood 2026 [4]) run through the 4Ps and customer journey [1]; for each item the same task was described twice – people only vs. with AI (photo essay, Visual 5). Same input for both: brand facts from [2], [4], the target segment above, and the halal/label rules.

AI instruction (illustrative): "Write 5 short ad messages for Gulf families about Bayan Sulu sweets in Arabic, English and Kazakh. Use only these facts; no health claims; mention the halal mark only if certified." **Criteria:** speed, number of versions, translation quality, brand voice, cultural fit and compliance – each row ends with a named person who checks.

Observed result or reasoned expectation (do not invent measured figures):
Reasoned expectation (no measured figures): AI does better at **speed** – many ad versions, one per group, in three languages, plus fast scanning of online reviews and competitor prices.

People do better at trust – local taste, partner meetings, halal and label rules, and the voice of a 50+ year brand [4]. Finding: AI prepares the options, a named person chooses (photo essay, Visual 6).

Which approach better serves the customer? What trade-off remains?
AI-supported with human sign-off better serves Gulf families: they get clearer messages in their own language sooner, and every claim is checked before it reaches them.

Remaining trade-off: speed and volume vs. accuracy and brand trust – a bad translation or a false halal/health claim could damage a brand the market does not know yet, so a native speaker and the brand manager must approve every ad [7].

D. Company A → Company B transfer

Documented comparator practice + source; verdict (ADOPT / ADAPT / PILOT / DELAY / REJECT) and why:
ADOPT – AI review and price scanning (industry practice): cheap and low risk; useful research before entering the Gulf. **ADAPT – Ferrero customer groups in Google BigQuery** ("Raw Data" by fifty-five, segments consumers for personalised content) [8]: Bayan Sulu has much less online data, so start with simple groups from distributor sales, with consent [5].

PILOT – Ferrero USA AI demand forecasting with Alloy.ai [10]: one product line, one UAE channel; return to manual planning if forecast error > 25% for 2 months. **DELAY – Ferrero's 7 million unique algorithm-designed Nutella labels** [9]: expensive, and Gulf families need to know the brand first.

REJECT – prices that change automatically: families could feel cheated, and Kazakhstan's 2026 amendments ban decisions made only by automated processing [5]. **Why overall:** Bayan Sulu is much smaller than Ferrero, with less customer data, so it should run one small Gulf pilot where AI prepares and a named person approves, then measure sales per store and repeat purchases before scaling.

E. Evidence

Sources (IEEE identifiers/URLs), screenshots or diagrams to include in Evidence Folder:

[1] L. J. Gitman et al., Introduction to Business, 2nd ed. Houston, TX, USA: OpenStax, 2026, chs. 11–13. [Online]. Available: https://openstax.org/details/books/introduction-business-2e

[2] JSC “Bayan Sulu,” “About Us,” bayansulu.kz. [Online]. Available: https://bayansulu.kz/en/about/o-kompanii/ (accessed Sep. 16, 2026).

[4] KazFoodProducts, “Bayan Sulu Confectionery Captivates Gulfood - 2026 and Expands into New Markets,” press release, Jan. 30, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://kfp.kz/en/press-center/baian-sulu-konditerlik-fabrikasy-gulfood-2026-kormesin-bagyndyrdy (accessed Oct. 14, 2026).

[5] A. Shyngyssov and B. Kadyrov, “Republic of Kazakhstan Data Protection Law: Amendments in 2026,” Morgan Lewis LawFlash, Jul. 14, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://www.morganlewis.com/pubs/2026/07/republic-of-kazakhstan-data-protection-law-amendments-in-2026

[7] National Institute of Standards and Technology, “Artificial Intelligence Risk Management Framework (AI RMF 1.0),” NIST AI 100-1, Jan. 2023, doi: 10.6028/NIST.AI.100-1.

[8] Google Cloud, “Ferrero Case Study.” [Online]. Available: https://cloud.google.com/customers/ferrero (accessed Sep. 17, 2026).

[9] Futurism, “An Algorithm Designed 7 Million One-Of-A-Kind Labels for a Nutella Campaign.” [Online]. Available: https://futurism.com/an-algorithm-designed-7-million-one-of-a-kind-labels-for-a-nutella-campaign (accessed Sep. 17, 2026).

[10] Alloy.ai, “Ferrero USA Selects Alloy.ai for Digital Supply Chain Management.” [Online]. Available: https://alloy.ai/alloy-selected-by-ferrero-usa-for-digital-supply-chain-management (accessed Sep. 16, 2026).

Numbering follows the A3 photo essay reference list ([3] StockAnalysis and [6] Baker McKenzie are cited in other visuals).

Evidence Folder: Visual 4 – screenshot of the Gulfood press release [4]; Visual 3 – customer journey diagram (friction at Consideration); Visual 5 – people-only vs. with-AI comparison (method); Visual 6 – result; Visual 10 – transfer verdict; own shelf photo of Bayan Sulu products, Astana (Visual 1).